



HABITS AND STATES IN THE PAST AND PRESENT

PRESENT SIMPLE

- The present simple tense is used to express repeated , habitual actions in the present .
- We often use the present simple with :
 - adverbs of frequency , that go before the main verb , and after be . These adverbs are : *always , usually , regularly , normally , frequently , often , sometimes , occasionally and never* .

E.g They **usually** play football on Sunday .

-expressions of frequency that go at the end of the sentence or verb phrase, such as : *every day , once a week , two times* .

E.g I go to the gym **twice a week**.

PRESENT SIMPLE AND USED TO

- In order to explain that a past action doesn't happen in the present, we use : **any more/any longer** with the present simple to contrast with used to.

E.g I used to eat a lot of chocolate but I don't (eat) it any more .

HABITS IN THE PAST

- For past habits we use **used to/didn't use to + infinitive**.
("used to" does not exist in the present tense).
 - Used to refers to past habits and states which were true in the past but are not true any more.

E.g I **used to smoke** a packet a day but I stopped two years ago.

- "Used to/didn't use to" can be used with action verbs (e.g go,take,do etc.) and non-action verbs (e.g be,have,love,like etc.)

E.g I **used to drive** to work but now I take the bus.
I **didn't use to like** him but now I do.

- **Never used to** has the same meaning as **didn't use to**.

HABITS IN THE PAST

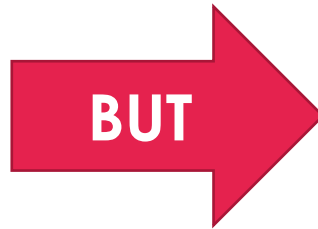
- We can also use the past simple to express habits and states that existed during a period of time in the past. This period can be mentioned or understood .

E.g When I was a child, I **visited** my grandmother **every weekend**.

USED TO OR PAST SIMPLE?

- “Used to” and past simple have the same meaning for repeated actions or states.

E.g I used to go to the cinema.
I went to the cinema.



- If the action happened only once, or we mention exact dates or number of time , we have to use past simple.

E.g I went to the cinema once a week.